Strategic Plan 2016-2019 Report



Calvary Women's Services

Ending homelessness. Inspiring hope. Transforming lives.

Three Strategic Directions

We set three strategic directions to guide our work and actively engage all levels of the organization over the three years, 2016 – 2019.

Housing. Increasing the affordable housing available to women and continuing to pair housing with comprehensive, trauma-informed and personalized support services.

Livelihood. Expanding opportunities for women to secure sustainable income through employment and/or government benefits that will result in long-term stability.

Leadership. Raising our voice as a leader advocating with and for women in our community, leading to improved housing and services for women, greater visibility for the organization and its replicable model and expanded opportunities for collaboration.

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Housing

Increase our permanent supportive housing

We will add at least 20 new permanent supportive housing units for women through either a new Calvary-owned site and/or apartment-based placements. Calvary has developed best practices in the permanent supportive housing model through its Sister Circle program. Having purchased and renovated its Good Hope Road building in 2010, Calvary has the experience to purchase a single site that could co-locate additional permanent supportive housing units and other programs. We maintain our commitment to the wards 7 & 8 communities and strive to develop housing in one of these wards, ideally in close proximity to our existing housing locations.

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Housing Results

- By the end of calendar year 2019, Calvary will have exceeded its goal and opened 45 new housing slots for single women, increasing its capacity by over 80%
- Secured three government funded grants to open Reach Up, a 31 bed transitional housing program for women that includes 15 beds for single women fleeing domestic violence
- Reach Up funded by The Community Partnership (10 beds), HUD (6 beds), and Office of Victims Services and Justice Grants/OVSJG (15 beds) – first time applying for and receiving funding from OVSJG
- Secured additional HUD funding to open 9 beds of short-term subsidized housing (Reach Up SSH)
- Secured additional funding from HUD to expand Sister Circle permanent supportive housing from 11 to 16 slots – able to add the new units at one of the two apartment complexes where this program is based
- Conducted an initial real estate search for a building/property to purchase with a group of business partners – given challenges in the current real estate market, decided to lease a property in ward 8 for the single-site transitional housing

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Livelihood

Expand Step Up DC, our employment search and placement program

We will expand the size and scope of the employment search and placement program to serve more women, possibly through a collaborative partnership. While the priority is maintaining a link between housing and employment, we are open to providing employment services for low-income and homeless women independent of a housing program.

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Livelihood Results

- Joined the collaborative at Skyland Workforce Center in summer 2017, offering job search and placement services to women
- Successful in serving women in need of employment services in wards 7 and 8 – most of whom are not housed at Calvary
- Changes at the Skyland Workforce Center have meant less foot traffic through the center and fewer nonprofit organizations committed to the collaborative
- Decisions regarding the nature of our on-going participation pending the opening of Reach Up transitional housing in fall 2019

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Leadership

Lift up women's voices and advocate for housing, services and opportunities

We will engage in focused networking and advocacy to lift up women's voices, highlight the need for housing and services for women and actively promote Calvary's successful model. Calvary will also increase our visibility within the community. This effort will require a strategic communications expertise beyond Calvary's current capacity, so we will determine an appropriate plan for securing this important resource.

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Leadership Results

- Completed a Strategic Communications Plan with the assistance of consultant group, Woodside Strategies
- Full-time Communications Manager resourced by Woodside Strategies for one year with foundation grant funding – successful social media metrics outcomes over last two years
- Rebranded with new collateral materials, updated logo and tag line, etc.
- Expanded leadership in the homeless services community (leadership of Women's Task Force and the Trauma work group of the DC Interagency Council on Homelessness), advocacy community (Coalition of Nonprofit Housing and Economic Development and LISC's Elevating Equity project), and in the domestic violence provider community (DC Collaborative on Domestic Violence and Human Services)
- Provided leadership to the 2017 DC Women's Needs Assessment that opened doors to increased funding for housing and services for single women and a greater coordination between homeless services and domestic violence services

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